

7.2 Receipt Organization System

A filing method that keeps every receipt findable — for warranty claims, tax time, and disputes years after the build.

Why Receipt Organization Matters

Proper receipt organization is essential for:

- Tracking expenses accurately and staying within budget
- Warranty claims and returns
- Tax deductions and documentation for the IRS
- Insurance claims in case of loss or damage
- Resolving payment disputes with vendors
- Proving costs if you sell the property

RECEIPT ORGANIZATION INSTRUCTIONS

1. Label Envelopes or Folders by Month and Category

Create a filing system using large envelopes, accordion folders, or a filing box. Label each section with:

- Month and Year (e.g., "January 2024")
- Budget Category (see list below)

Example: "January 2024 - Foundation" or "March 2024 - Framing"

2. File Receipts Immediately

When you return from a purchase or receive a receipt:

- Record the expense in your Expense Tracking Sheet (Section 7.1) the same day
- Write the corresponding expense log entry number on the receipt
- File the receipt in the appropriate envelope/folder immediately
- Check the "Receipt Filed" box in your expense log
- Note the receipt location (envelope/folder label) in your expense log

3. Note Any Missing Receipts

If you cannot locate a receipt:

- Mark "N" for Receipt Filed in your expense log
- Write "MISSING RECEIPT" in the Receipt Location column
- Try to obtain a duplicate from the vendor
- If unavailable, write a memo documenting the purchase (date, vendor, amount, items purchased)

- Attach credit card/bank statement showing the transaction

4. Digital Backup Recommended

To protect against loss or damage:

- Scan or photograph all receipts (especially thermal receipts that fade)
- Store digital copies in organized folders on your computer or cloud storage
- Use the same naming convention: "2024-01-Foundation-Receipt-001.pdf"
- Back up digital files regularly to an external drive or cloud service

RECEIPT ORGANIZATION CATEGORIES

Organize your receipts using these budget categories. Create a separate envelope or folder section for each, and tick it off once the folder exists.

Folder Index

	Category	Examples of Items/Services
☐	Site Preparation	Clearing, grading, excavation, driveway
☐	Foundation	Concrete, rebar, forms, waterproofing, footer materials
☐	Framing	Lumber, engineered beams, joists, sheathing, fasteners
☐	Roofing	Shingles, underlayment, drip edge, vents, flashing
☐	Exterior	Siding, windows, doors, trim, house wrap
☐	Rough-In	Plumbing pipes, electrical wire, HVAC equipment, fixtures
☐	Insulation	Fiberglass batts, spray foam, rigid foam boards
☐	Drywall	Drywall sheets, joint compound, tape, screws
☐	Flooring	Hardwood, tile, carpet, underlayment, adhesives
☐	Cabinets	Kitchen cabinets, bathroom vanities, countertops
☐	Fixtures	Sinks, toilets, faucets, light fixtures, appliances
☐	Paint	Interior paint, exterior paint, primer, brushes, rollers
☐	Permits	Building permits, inspection fees, impact fees
☐	Other	Landscaping, garage door, miscellaneous hardware

RECEIPT STORAGE CHECKLIST

- ☐ Envelopes or folders labeled with month and category
- ☐ All receipts filed within 24 hours of purchase
- ☐ Receipt numbers match expense log entries
- ☐ Missing receipts documented with memos and statements
- ☐ Digital backup system established
- ☐ Receipts scanned or photographed weekly
- ☐ Digital files backed up to cloud or external drive
- ☐ Receipt storage kept in secure, dry location
- ☐ All receipts retained for at least 7 years after project completion

NOTES

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal blue or grey ruling lines, typical of notebook paper. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There is no handwriting or other markings on the paper.